CORNELL TECH X COLUMBIA X GONA SEMICONDUCTORS

EmpireHacks 2026

GONA-SEMI

audos

Alacriti

ANTHROP\C

CORNELL TECH AI Society

Lovable

McKinsey & Company

EliseAI

aws

AI Club Columbia Business School

Logistics

Friday

TIME	EVENT 1	LOCATION 1
4:00 – 4:30 PM	Day 1 Kickoff: *Logistics, Theme Reveal, Judge Introduction*	Zoom
4:30 – 6:00 PM	Online Team Matching and Networking Session	Zoom: Breakout Rooms by Theme
6:00 PM – EOD	Build Time for Teams	Async

Saturday

TIME	EVENT 1	LOCATION 1
10:00 – 11:00 AM	Day 2 Kickoff: *Logistics and Submission Details*	Zoom
11:00 AM – EOD	Build Time for Teams	Async

Sunday

TIME	EVENT 1	LOCATION 1	EVENT 2	LOCATION 2
9:00 – 10:00 AM	Check-In and Breakfast	Bloomberg 161/165	—	—
10:00 – 10:30 AM	Day 3 Kickoff	Bloomberg Auditorium	—	—
10:30 – 11:30 AM	Workshop 1	Bloomberg Auditorium	Build Session for Teams	Bloomberg 161/165 Overflow Room 061
11:30 AM – 12:30 PM	Workshop 2	Bloomberg Auditorium	Build Session for Teams	Bloomberg 161/165 Overflow Room 061
12:30 – 2:00 PM	Networking Hour + Lunch	Bloomberg 161/165 Overflow Room 061	—	—
2:00 – 3:30 PM	Keynote Speaker Panel + AMA	Bloomberg Auditorium	Build Session for Teams (Submissions Due at 3:00 PM)	Bloomberg 161/165
3:00 PM	Submissions Due	—	—	—
3:00 – 4:00 PM	Judging (Judges Only)	Bloomberg Auditorium	Networking Hour for Attendees	Bloomberg 161/165
4:00 – 5:00 PM	Finalist Demos, Awards, Closing Remarks	Bloomberg Auditorium	—	—

Theme Reveal and Prizes

Track 1: The Operator

Three tracks. One mission: build agents that do real work.

Enterprise Agents for Work

Autonomous Agents That Finish the Job

Messy Inputs · Multi-step · External Integration

Prompt	Core Characteristics
Build an autonomous operator that bridges the gap between messy data and meaningful execution. ● Ingest inputs, integrates tools/APIs, and deliver a real output in an external system. ● Orchestrates tasks across multiple formats or sources of info.	1. Agentic Autonomy 2. Tool Use & Integration 3. Multimodal & Unstructured Robustness 4. State & Context Mgmt.

Full prompts, examples, and judging rubric available in the Track Guide.

Track 2: The Auditor

Three tracks. One mission: build agents that do real work.

Regulated Agents for Trust

High-Stakes Agents You Can Actually Trust

Sensitive Tasks · Traceability · Risk & Safety

Prompt	Core Characteristics
Build an agent that you'd trust can handle sensitive tasks where mistakes are expensive or regulations are strict. • Make the reasoning transparent enough that a human reviewer can verify every decision. • Cite sources, flag uncertainty, and escalate when needed.	1. Traceability & Evidence 2. Correctness & Risk Handling 3. Rule-to-Action Translation 4. Safety-by-Design

Full prompts, examples, and judging rubric available in the Track Guide.

Track 3: The Sidekick

Three tracks. One mission: build agents that do real work.

Adaptive Agents for People

Human-Centered Agents That Adapt to You

Personalization · Usability · Contextual Awareness

Prompt	Core Characteristics
Build an agent that adapts to the user and directly interacts with people in its task. ● Anticipate needs, reduce friction, and adapts to automate ways people work, create, or learn. ● Respect privacy and keep the human in control.	1. Adaptation & Personalization 2. Interaction Design 3. Contextual Awareness & Anticipation 4. Ethics & Accessibility

Full prompts, examples, and judging rubric available in the Track Guide.

Choose Your Track

Three tracks. One mission: build agents that do real work.

The Operator

Messy Inputs · Multi-step · Tool Integration

The Auditor

Regulations · Traceability · Risk Management

The Sidekick

Personalization · User feedback · Ethics and Accessibility

Full prompts, examples, and judging rubric available in the Track Guide.

Hackathon Awards: By Theme

Best Hack (Enterprise Agents for Work)

Awarded to the best agent that autonomously turns messy, real-world data into meaningful, end-to-end outcomes.

Best Hack (Regulated Agents for Trust)

Awarded to the agent that most effectively handles high-risk scenarios with accuracy, transparency, and responsible decision-making.

Best Hack (Adaptive Agents for People)

Awarded to the agent that best enhances the user experience by being intuitive, adaptive, and human-aware.

Beats Solo Buds for all winning team members!

Hackathon Awards: Event-Wide

Best Hack (Overall)

Awarded to the project that demonstrates the strongest combination of innovation, impact, and execution.

Grand Prize: Meta Ray Ban Glasses for all winning team members!

Most Creative Demo Video

Awarded to the team with the most original, engaging, and well-designed demo video, chosen by crowd vote (no self-voting).

Beats Solo Buds for all winning team members!

Reminders

Reminders!!

- *Make sure to sign up for Anthropic and Lovable Credits (See Slack)*
- *Team Matching Networking Hour right after this!*